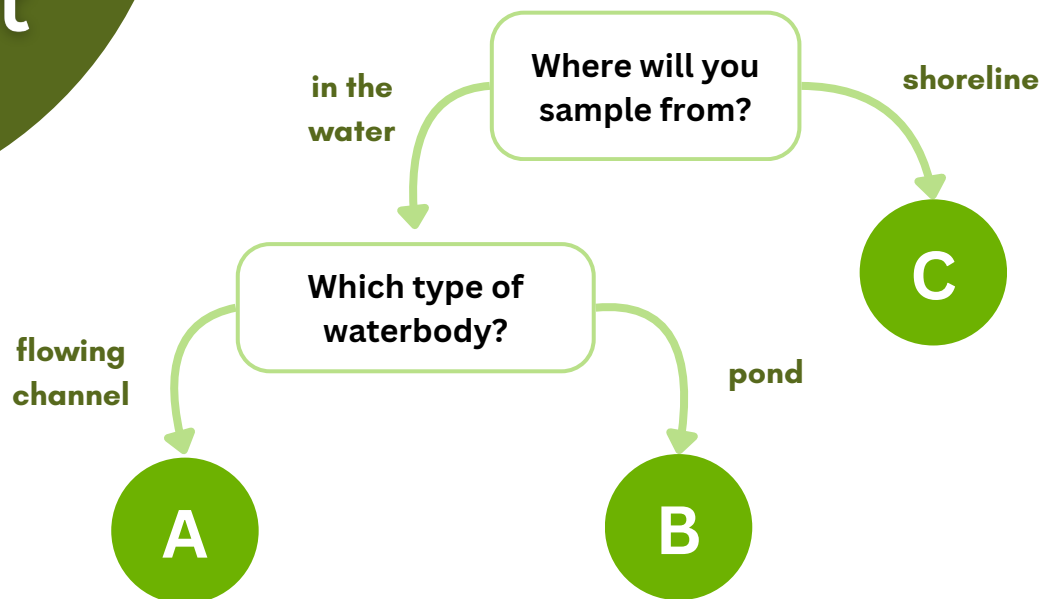


Benthic HAB SOP field cheat sheet

First time? Please
follow the full SOP
found [here](#)

Step 1. Choose your assessment method



Step 2. Conduct coverage assessment

Target recreational areas with minimal disturbance

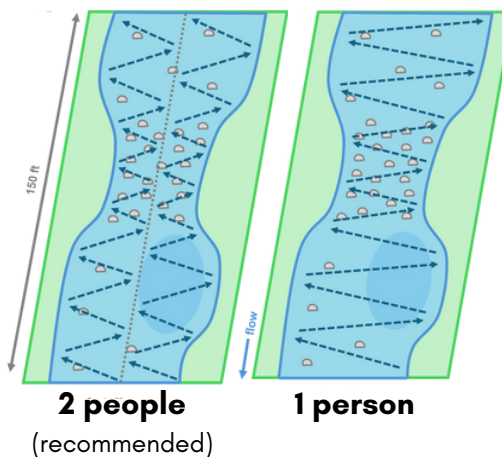
A

Begin downstream and wade 150 ft upstream in a zig-zag pattern

B

Start at opposite ends of 150 ft area of pond and wade towards each other

In water survey

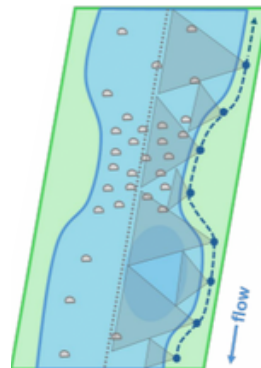


C

Begin downstream and walk 150 ft upstream along the shoreline

If ponded, walk toward windward side; if no wind walk approx. west to east

shoreline



Choose area with minimal disturbance. First, visually assess sample area, taking note of % coverage.

For ponds and wide/unwadeable channels, sample segment should extend 30 ft wide **or** until you are knee deep (~0.5 m)

Step 3. Record data from survey

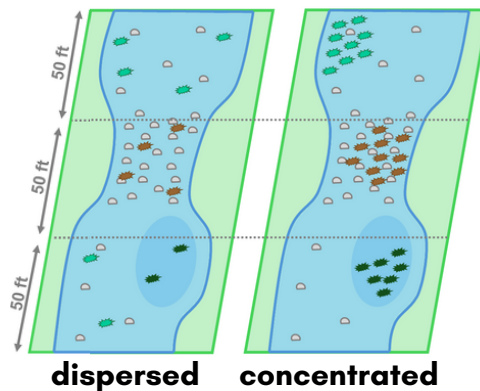
A. Visual hazards

Mats growing in puddles onshore, or detached and accumulated onshore

Mats peeling from substrates or at risk of detaching

Floating mats in stagnant areas or flowing downstream

B. Distribution

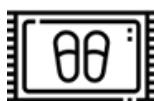


C. Size class

What size is the largest mat?



basketball

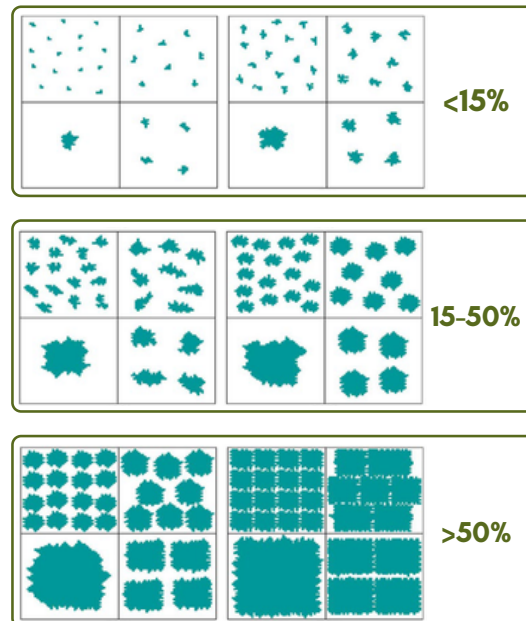


doormat



sedan

D. Percent cover



Step 4. Collect samples

A. Ambient water



1/4 full

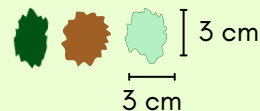
B. Composite mat sample



TIPS

Try to collect
different
morphotypes

Aim for 3 pieces of
mat material at
each location



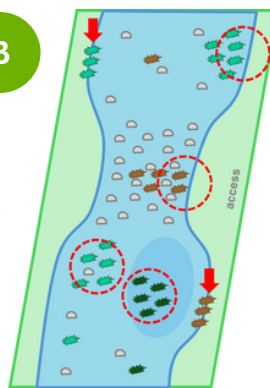
in water

A

B

2 hotspots in water
and 2 hotspots near
shoreline

4 locations x 3 pieces =
12 pieces total



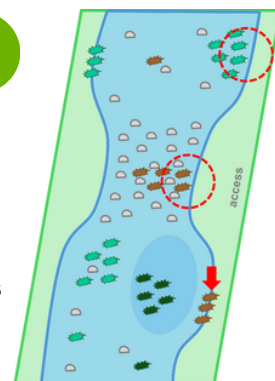
in water

shoreline

C

2-4 hotspots
near shoreline

If <4 hotspots,
collect more pieces
at each spot for 12
pieces total



shoreline

Step 5. Store & ship samples

- Hold time for lab receipt is 5 days
- Store in a dark cooler or refrigerator (2-8° C)
- Do NOT freeze samples
- Ship samples overnight
- Do NOT ship on a Friday or Saturday



Resources

[List of potential labs](#)

[Example COC](#)

- Include completed form in a Ziplock bag
- Email lab with COC

Email cyanoHAB.reports@waterboards.ca.gov
with questions about this SOP